THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which statement best describes the story's central irony? 1

(a) a rich man becomes poor
(b) a wrestler wins
(c) a thief is reformed by the trust of the man he planned to rob
(d) a writer becomes a thief

2. Which of the following best captures Ruskin Bond's attitude to Hari? 1

(a) fear **(b)** mockery
(c) compassionate understanding **(d)** contempt

3. Which of these words has a positive connotation? 1

(a) theft **(b)** betray **(c)** deceive **(d)** reform

4. The narrator's honesty about his own crimes makes him: 1

(a) a reliable and sympathetic narrator **(b)** a victim of the law
(c) a hero **(d)** a liar

5. The ending is 'open' in that: 1

(a) the thief is caught
(b) we imagine Hari's future after the lessons
(c) Anil leaves
(d) the story continues forever

6. The phrase 'honour among thieves' is ironic here because Hari: 1

(a) steals from thieves **(b)** is honoured
(c) is a policeman **(d)** betrays a friend and then repents

7. If Anil had been a suspicious person, which theme would be lost? 1

(a) poverty **(b)** the transforming power of trust
(c) friendship with animals **(d)** education

8. Which pair of themes is most central? 1

(a) trust and redemption **(b)** travel and exile
(c) wealth and power **(d)** fame and ambition

9. Which narrative technique reveals Hari's feelings best? 1

(a) a newspaper clip **(b)** interior monologue
(c) a letter **(d)** a map

10. The story argues that crime is mainly: 1

(a) shaped by circumstance and open to change
(b) punished only by prison
(c) inborn and fixed
(d) a game

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Analyse how the title shapes the reader's expectations. 2

12. What is the significance of the train in the story? 2

13. Suggest an alternative ending and comment on its effect. 2

14. Why is Anil's lack of knowledge about the theft crucial? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss how Ruskin Bond uses simplicity of language to convey a profound theme. 3

16. Evaluate the role of chance in Hari's change. 3

17. Write about the narrator's tone when describing himself. 3

OR

Examine the claim that the story is more about Anil than Hari. 3

18. Compare 'The Thief's Story' with the idea that 'a leopard cannot change its spots'. 3

OR

What are the ethical questions raised by the story? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'The Thief's Story is a tale of redemption through trust.' Critically examine. 5

OR

Write a dialogue between Hari and a friend who urges him to keep the money. 5

20. Compare Hari at the wrestling match with Hari at the railway station. 5

OR

Analyse the structure of the story: exposition, rising action, climax, resolution. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND